



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text 'against compatibilist free will' in white.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee.
2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee, then her act of poisoning the coffee is free.
3. Isabel's act of poisoning the coffee is free.
(1,2)
4. Isabel had no choice about the chip being inserted into her brain.
5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain necessitates that she will poison the coffee.

- C. An act can be free even if it is necessitated by facts about which the agent has no choice.
(3,4,5)

THE FRANKFURT ARGUMENT

It is natural to think that they must object to either (1) or (2), since (4) and (5) just specify features of the example. But (1) looks tough to deny.

How about (2)? One might agree that there is a tight link between freedom and responsibility without saying that **every** act for which you are responsible is a free act. Sometimes you can be responsible for acts which are not free but which are 'downstream' from free acts of yours.



2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the

Can't act can be free even if it is not at all



neccessitates that she will provide.

1. Isabel is responsible for providing the coffee.



4. Isabel had no chance about the chip being

(1, 2)

coftee, then her act of poisoning the coffee is

inserted into her brain.

5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain

3. Isabel's act of imprisoning the confessor is free.

(3, 4, 5)

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We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

0. There is no fire in.

Wili.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

for (2), and one for (3).





1. No one has any choice about events which

varlatatie + the last of the

about whether @.

theorie about the fact that if DNR

2. None has any choice about DIDS ATJR.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

3. If determined, the only one



nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

happened in the distant past.

of interest.

then DECISION. (4,5)

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

and none has any choice about whether,

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

future is not just what the state of the

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

then DECISION happens. (3)

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

choice about the laws of nature, then no

combination of four - that No

choice principle, and determinism

rules out free will.

seem quite plausible, the argument

seems to show that if determinism is

hence that free will is incompatible with

true, there are no free actions — and

Since the first three of these theses

dearminism.





Wili.

0: There is no fire will.

1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free



Real/|the master argument:

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

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A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

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